



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Fort Worth
School Website: <https://www.foundersfortworth.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy – Fort Worth (76108) presents a recognizably classical orientation in its public-facing materials. The school consistently foregrounds classical education, virtue, and formation, and it emphasizes partnership with families and a liberal-arts-inspired curriculum. However, some elements central to the strongest classical model (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation pedagogy, direct Socratic seminar practices, a living-teacher-as-model framework, liturgical/theological grounding, and explicit memory/recitation practices) are not evident in the publicly available content. On balance, the school demonstrates meaningful classical tendencies, but several core elements are not fully documented in public communications. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with notable strength in School Purpose/Goal and Parents & Community, and more limited public evidence for some aspects of Curriculum and Pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The home page motto emphasizes “Knowledge, Virtue and Liberty,” signaling virtue and transcendent aims (truth, goodness, beauty as ideals) though not explicit theology or liturgical practice.
 - The “Who We Are” statements describe a classical approach oriented to truth, beauty, and goodness and a liberal-arts-leaning curriculum.
 - Public communications frame education as formation of virtuous citizens rather than mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: virtue, truth, beauty, classical education, formation (not information), liberal arts orientation.
 - Negative keywords: not evidenced in public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or instrumental/worker-education signals in these texts).
 - Quantitative note: multiple positive indicators identified; no explicit negative indicators found in the public materials sampled.
- Why this rating
 - The materials affirm transcendental aims (virtue, truth, beauty) and a classical orientation, but they do not explicitly document theology, liturgy, or liturgical practices. This yields a strong but not full fulfillment of the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations criteria.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit statement that the end of public education is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people who are prepared to flourish.
 - Emphasis on formation and moral development in tandem with knowledge; the school describes aims beyond job preparation, focusing on virtue and human flourishing.
 - Language around a liberal arts orientation and “classical mission” in public messaging.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive keywords: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, great conversation (where present in related docs), classical mission.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials (no emphasis on workforce readiness or 21st-century skills as primary goals in these texts).
 - Quantitative note: robust presence of formation/virtue-oriented language with no explicit negative-workforce signals in the sampled texts.
 - Why this rating
 - The school's stated goals align with classical aims to cultivate virtue and wisdom, focusing on formation over mere information and on human excellence. This aligns closely with Classical criteria for School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public statements describe a classical approach with a traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum.
 - Emphasis on liberal arts orientation, which is a hallmark of classical curricula (even if explicit mentions of the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or Great Conversation are not spelled out in the site text).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical education, traditional curriculum.
 - Negative keywords present: not evident in public materials (no explicit replacement of history with social studies language; no overt emphasis on project-based or STEM-first framing in the sampled texts).
 - Quantitative note: positive signals present (liberal arts; traditional curriculum) but key classical curriculum markers often emphasized in inspection (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation) are not explicitly stated on the site texts reviewed.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum description signals a classical, liberal-arts approach, but the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and the Seven Liberal Arts markers in public statements leads to a partial fulfillment rather than full CLASSICAL status in this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site describes a classical approach with a liberal-arts curriculum and a whole-group teaching modality, with an emphasis on critical thinking and character development.
 - There is evidence of a mix of restfulness and rigor in messaging, but explicit mentions of Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, or routine recitation (central in some classical models) are not clearly documented in the public site texts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (not explicitly present in public FCA Fort Worth texts), great conversation, guided discussion, reflection (implicit in formation language), discussion-based learning (not explicit in these site texts), restfulness (Scholé) (not explicit in these texts).
 - Negative keywords present: experiential learning-focused, project-based learning dominance (not evidenced in the FCA Fort Worth public materials cited here).
 - Quantitative note: Pedagogy signals exist in a general classical framing but lack explicit documentation of key classical methods (Socratic seminars, recitation, chanting, and memory work) in the public materials we reviewed.
- Why this rating
 - The school presents a classical pedagogy posture, but the absence of explicit, documented Socratic, memorization/recitation, and chant-based memory practices in public materials reduces it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials profile a Headmaster and staff but do not articulate a distinct “living curriculum” concept, teacher portraits, or a formal faculty-as-mentors living within the curriculum. The materials emphasize staff warmth and partnership but do not present a documented “faculty as living curriculum,” or a teacher-portrait standard in the public communications reviewed.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present in notionally related terms: “Headmaster” and “staff” (qualitative evidence of qualified teachers) but not the explicit classical-faculty markers (e.g., “teachers as models of virtue,” “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum,” “faculty of friends,” etc.) as defined in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
 - Negative keywords present: explicit references to “living curriculum” or teacher-portrait language are not documented in the public materials.
 - Quantitative note: minimal alignment with the explicit Faculty criteria; no clear evidence of the classical-faculty hallmarks.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials do not demonstrate the explicit faculty concepts central to classical education (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait-identity of teacher). This category does not meet the core markers in the evidence available, yielding a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school actively communicates with families via Parent Information Nights and related events, and frames partnership with families in its public messaging (e.g., invitation language; “we look forward to partnering with you in the education of your scholar”).
 - There are explicit references to parent/community involvement in events, newsletters, and family engagement opportunities (e.g., parent nights, community events, and communications).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, parent formation, family involvement, home-school synergy, open campus, parental participation.
 - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials (no signals of “customer” or minimal parent involvement).
 - Quantitative note: multiple explicit positive indicators; no explicit negative indicators detected in the publicly available communications.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates clear, documented efforts to engage parents and to welcome family involvement, aligning strongly with the Parents & Community criteria in the classical framework.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings:
 - Element 1 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 2 — CLASSICAL
 - Element 3 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 4 — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 5 — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6 — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Rationale
 - A plurality of categories (2 and 6) reach CLASSICAL, but three categories (1, 3, 4) are only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, and one category (5) is NOT CLASSICAL. Taken together, the school exhibits substantial classical tendencies, especially in School Purpose/Goal and Parents/Community, but several core elements (Pedagogy, Curriculum specifics like Great Books, and the

Faculty living-curriculum concept) are not fully evidenced in the publicly available materials. The net result is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations)
 - Add explicit articulation of theology or a liturgical/framework-friendly dimension in public communications.
 - Reference liturgical or communal practices (even if nonsectarian in policy) to demonstrate liturgical rhythm, sacred music, or communal worship aspects aligned with the classical-educational tradition.
- Element 3 (Curriculum)
 - Explicitly enumerate Great Books, primary sources, and the Great Conversation as core components of the curriculum.
 - Emphasize specific Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) where applicable, and connect historical transmission through primary Western texts.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy)
 - Document explicit use of Socratic seminars or dialectic discussions in classrooms (especially at upper levels), recitation/memorization practices, and memory-work aligned with classical pedagogy.
 - Describe how Scholé/restful learning is implemented and balanced with rigorous study, including a rhythm that demonstrates contemplation and rest in the learning process.
- Element 5 (Faculty)
 - Develop and publish a “living curriculum” concept for faculty and a clear portrait of the teacher as a model of virtue.
 - Articulate professional development and teacher mentorship practices that embed classical pedagogy, high moral formation, and collaborative faculty culture.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community)
 - Expand parent-formation programming (book studies, discussions on classical education philosophy) and articulate formal channels for parent feedback and co-educator roles.
 - Publicly emphasize open-campus policies and more routine parent involvement in school governance or advisory roles.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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